

Group Method. In the training centres the main method used is the group method. It is not the main field contact method. This is obvious, but unfortunately it is not the actual contact staff to use to make the most of the best method for the vast majority of cases. It is also, however, the best method to use to get farmers to adopt new ideas and technical advice. For each person has to learn the facts for himself as an individual, it is especially the group--his fellow villagers, tribesmen, or countrymen--who are to facilitate or hinder the adoption of new ideas. This has been found many times in developing countries. A progressive farmer may want to carry out innovations, but if he violates or upsets the group norms in any way, or if there is a suspicion that this may be so, that farmer will soon be brought down to size; If the person involved is one whom they cannot effectively ignore him and his ideas.

From the extension worker's point of view the individual method is the most effective. He has the full personal contact which helps him feel that he is dealing with someone with a definite problem which can be investigated fully and rectified on the spot. Unfortunately, the time and costs involved preclude individual contact with all farmers. It is not likely, due to the staffing situation, that there will change for a long time to come, although it will be seen later in this report that there is probably too much individual contact at present for the country's manpower resources.

The individual method, as the term implies, is used in individual method. This is a very important part of extension, because extension worker cannot establish a rapport with at least some of his farmers, then there is every chance that his attempts at effective group contacts with farmers. It is basically through individual visits and contact that the extension worker is going to gauge the results and effectiveness of his teaching. Through the individual follow-up, the effectiveness of training sessions carried out at the training centres is assessed.

These results have been achieved through a combination of methods--individual- and mass-used--in varying degrees as circumstances dictate (Verner and [redacted], 1964).

It even without colonial influences. An example of the present situation seen recently in a village beside Bunda College, where the college staff and carry out agricultural, home economics, and general rural-development work. A meeting had been called to discuss the business of the local Savings and to discuss fertilizer requirements for the coming season. It was practically impossible to get the group to arrive at any decision; the question always back: "What do you (the college) want us to do?" And this was in a situation where the college had been trying very hard to encourage local responsibility in decision-making; It is easy, therefore, to imagine the situation over most of the country where the agricultural extension staff in most cases do not have sufficient time to initiate and train people in decision-making as a definitive part of extension programmes. Despite the directive overtones of their program, the government extension services have been making headway in the field of training.